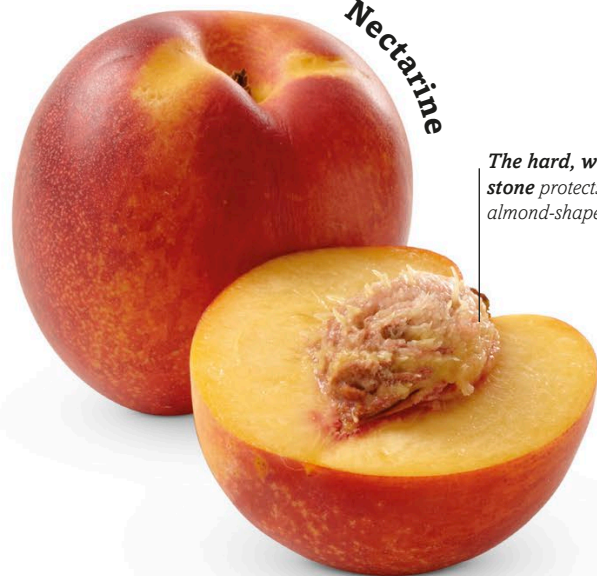




Sloe

These small, slightly sour fruits are used to make preserves and flavor spirits.



Nectarine

The hard, wrinkled stone protects an almond-shaped seed.

This fragrant fruit is eaten both fresh and dried.



Apricot



Dates

Date palms can produce up to **310 lb (140 kg)** of fruit each year.

These high-growing fruits are picked with the help of ropes, ladders, or cherry-picker trucks.

The pulp of this bitter fruit is used to make jams.



Damson

its fuzzy skin and prefer its smooth relative, the **nectarine**. Some stone fruits are not sweet but sour—the **sloe** must be cooked up with lots of sugar. The flesh of **olives** is hard as well as bitter. But when crushed in a press, a greenish-gold oil can be extracted. Some stone fruits, such

as **almonds**, are grown for their edible seeds rather than their flesh. Some people do eat whole unripe green almonds, which are fuzzy, crunchy, and tart, with a soft, jelly-filled seed.